THE Estate Organiser

A FREE GUIDE · THE ESTATE ORGANISER

The Executor Toolkit

Everything the person who steps up needs: a clear path through the first days and the months that follow.

- The first 48 hours, step by step
- The executor timeline, week by week
- Common executor mistakes to avoid
- Expense log and notification templates

"Being an executor is hard enough. This makes it simpler."

A FREE GUIDE FROM THE ESTATE ORGANISER AUSTRALIA

theestateorganiser.com.au

GENERAL INFORMATION ONLY. NOT LEGAL, FINANCIAL OR TAX ADVICE.
LAWS VARY BY AUSTRALIAN STATE AND TERRITORY.

Executor Roadmap & First 48 Hours Checklist

The first 48 hours after a death are chaotic.

Your executor will be dealing with their own grief while also handling urgent practical matters. They need to secure property, notify key people, and start organising paperwork.

This checklist helps them prioritise what needs to happen immediately and what can wait.

The first 48 hours: Secure, Notify, Record

Your Executor Roadmap & First 48 Hours Checklist

A step-by-step path through the first hours and days, so nothing urgent is missed.

WITHIN THE FIRST FEW HOURS

- [ ] Secure the person's home (lock up, set alarm, collect mail, pets, plants)
- [ ] Locate the Will (check Part 2; contact the solicitor who drafted it)
- [ ] Locate this Estate Organiser and read the Message to Your Executor
- [ ] Contact immediate family (see Key Contacts)

WITHIN THE FIRST 24 HOURS

- [ ] Obtain the Medical Certificate of Cause of Death

> *This is the doctor's certificate that lets funeral arrangements begin. It is not the official death certificate, which usually arrives a few weeks later, after the death is registered. Most banks and institutions will wait for the official one.*

- [ ] Register the death (your funeral director usually does this; timeframes vary by state, so check with them, and order multiple certificates)
- [ ] Contact the funeral director (check the Funeral chapter for wishes)
- [ ] Notify the deceased's employer (final pay, leave, super)
- [ ] Secure valuable items (jewellery, cash, documents) and record them

Your Executor Roadmap & First 48 Hours Checklist (cont.)

WITHIN THE FIRST 48 HOURS

- [ ] Notify close friends (see Key Contacts)
- [ ] Contact the solicitor
- [ ] Contact insurance companies (if death benefits apply)
- [ ] Arrange care for dependants
- [ ] Arrange care for pets
- [ ] Cancel immediate appointments
- [ ] Start a death administration notebook

NOTES: WHAT'S BEEN DONE, AND WHAT STILL NEEDS DOING

Executor Timeline

Being an executor is a marathon, not a sprint.

The work doesn't end after the first week. Settling an estate typically takes 6-12 months (sometimes longer if it's complicated).

This timeline breaks down what needs to happen at each stage: the first week, the first month, the first three months, and the first year.

Use this as a guide, not a strict schedule. Every estate is different. Some things will take longer than expected. Some will move faster. That's normal.

Your timeline: What to expect and when

Your Executor Timeline

What to do and when, from the first week through to the end of the first year.

THE FIRST WEEK

- [ ] Secure the property and valuables
- [ ] Register the death (usually handled by your funeral director; timeframes vary by state, and order multiple certificates)
- [ ] Arrange the funeral
- [ ] Locate the Will and this Estate Organiser
- [ ] Contact the solicitor
- [ ] Notify immediate family and close friends
- [ ] Secure all financial documents
- [ ] Start keeping detailed records

THE FIRST MONTH

- [ ] Apply for probate if required (timeframes vary by state and can take several weeks or longer, so check your state's Supreme Court registry)
- [ ] Notify all relevant organisations (banks, super, Centrelink, insurers)
- [ ] Cancel or transfer services
- [ ] Secure and value all assets
- [ ] Identify all debts
- [ ] Claim life insurance
- [ ] Claim super death benefits
- [ ] Keep paying urgent bills

Your Executor Timeline (cont.)

THE FIRST THREE MONTHS

- [ ] Obtain Grant of Probate (if applicable)
- [ ] Open an estate bank account
- [ ] Collect all assets
- [ ] Pay all debts in the correct order
- [ ] Lodge the final tax return
- [ ] Deal with property
- [ ] Manage business interests (if applicable)
- [ ] Cancel digital accounts (if instructed)
- [ ] Respond to creditors

THE FIRST SIX MONTHS

- [ ] Prepare estate accounts
- [ ] Obtain ATO clearance
- [ ] Prepare distribution schedule
- [ ] Communicate with beneficiaries
- [ ] Resolve any disputes

Your Executor Timeline (cont.)

THE FIRST YEAR

- [ ] Distribute the estate
- [ ] Finalise estate accounts
- [ ] Close the estate bank account
- [ ] Retain records
- [ ] Apply for an executor's commission only if you are entitled to one (this needs a clause in the Will, the agreement of all beneficiaries, or the court's approval, so check with your solicitor first)

NOTES: PROGRESS, DATES, AND ANYTHING OUTSTANDING

Common Executor Pitfalls & How to Avoid Them

Being an executor is harder than most people think.

There are legal steps, money to get right, and a lot of feeling to manage at the same time. It's easy to make mistakes, especially when you're grieving and under pressure from family.

This section covers the most common pitfalls executors face and how to avoid them.

Learn from other people's mistakes so you don't have to make them yourself.

Common mistakes and how to avoid them

PITFALL 1: Distributing assets too soon

THE MISTAKE: Executors sometimes distribute assets to beneficiaries before all debts are paid and all claims are settled. Then a creditor appears, or a tax bill arrives, and there's no money left to pay it.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- It is usually wise to hold off distributing until the estate's debts, claims and tax are properly dealt with. What that involves varies by estate, so have your accountant or solicitor confirm it is safe to distribute before you do. Ask your accountant or solicitor what applies to this estate.
- Wait until all debts are paid
- Wait until the creditor notice period has expired (the required notice period varies by state, so check with your solicitor for the period that applies to you)
- Keep a reserve in the estate account for unexpected expenses
- Get written approval from beneficiaries if you must distribute early

PITFALL 2: Not keeping detailed records

THE MISTAKE: Executors fail to document their actions, expenses, and decisions. Later, beneficiaries question what happened, and the executor can't prove what they did or why.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Start a detailed record-keeping system from day one
- Document every phone call, letter, email, and meeting
- Keep all receipts for expenses (even small ones)
- Take photos of property before selling or distributing
- Keep copies of everything
- Use Section 41 (Executor Expense Log) to track costs

PITFALL 3: Paying debts in the wrong order

THE MISTAKE: Not all debts are equal. Some must be paid first (like funeral costs and tax debts). Executors who pay debts in the wrong order can be held personally liable.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Work with a solicitor to understand debt priority
- Generally, the order is:
  Different kinds of debt rank differently, and the correct order is technical and varies by state, getting more complicated if the estate cannot cover everything. Confirm the right order with your solicitor before paying anyone, rather than relying on a general rule. The exact legal order varies by state, and gets more complicated if the estate can't cover everything, so confirm the correct order with your solicitor before paying anyone.
- Don't pay anyone until you know the full picture

PITFALL 4: Mixing personal and estate funds

THE MISTAKE: Executors use their own money to pay estate expenses, or they deposit estate money into their personal account. This creates confusion and can look like mismanagement.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Open a separate estate bank account immediately
- All estate income goes into this account
- All estate expenses are paid from this account
- Never mix it with your personal finances
- Keep the estate account separate until the estate is fully settled

PITFALL 5: Acting without probate when it's required

THE MISTAKE: Some executors try to access bank accounts, sell property, or distribute assets before getting Grant of Probate. Banks and institutions won't cooperate, and it wastes time.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Check with the solicitor whether probate is needed
- If required, apply for it before trying to access assets
- Whether probate is needed depends on the size of the estate and how each asset is held, and each bank or institution sets its own requirements. Confirm with the solicitor and each institution before assuming you can skip it.
- Wait for the Grant before taking action on major assets

PITFALL 6: Ignoring or delaying communication with beneficiaries

THE MISTAKE: Executors go silent. Beneficiaries don't know what's happening, assume the worst, and start making accusations or legal threats.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Send regular updates to beneficiaries (monthly or quarterly)
- Be transparent about timelines and delays
- Explain what you're doing and why
- Manage expectations (estates take time)
- Respond to questions promptly

PITFALL 7: Taking on too much alone

THE MISTAKE: Executors try to do everything themselves to save money. They get overwhelmed, make mistakes, and the estate takes years to settle.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Hire a solicitor. Yes, it costs money, but it's worth it.
- Use an accountant for tax matters
- Engage professionals for valuations (property, business, collectibles)
- Don't be a hero. This is too complex to do alone.

PITFALL 8: Selling assets too quickly (or too slowly)

THE MISTAKE: Executors panic-sell property at a loss because they feel pressured. Or they delay selling for years, racking up maintenance costs and frustrating beneficiaries.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Get professional valuations before selling anything
- Consult beneficiaries about major sales (if appropriate)
- Don't rush, but don't delay unnecessarily
- Consider market conditions (especially for property)
- Check the Will for specific instructions about selling

PITFALL 9: Not advertising for creditors

THE MISTAKE: Executors forget to advertise for creditors. A creditor appears after the estate is distributed, and the executor is personally liable.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Your solicitor will handle this
- In many situations advertising for creditors helps protect an executor, but whether and how to do it depends on where you are. Your solicitor will advise whether it applies to this estate.
- Advertise in newspapers and online
- There's a minimum notice period for claims, which varies by state, so your solicitor will confirm how long you need to wait
- Don't distribute until the period expires

PITFALL 10: Paying themselves without documentation

THE MISTAKE: Executors take a fee without documenting it or getting beneficiary approval. Beneficiaries accuse them of theft.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Executors are not automatically entitled to a fee. You can only claim a commission if the Will allows it, all the beneficiaries agree, or the court approves it. The amount is whatever is reasonable for the work done, and the court sets an upper limit rather than a fixed rate. Check with your solicitor before claiming anything.
- Document your time and effort
- Get written approval from beneficiaries before taking a fee
- Be transparent about what you're claiming
- Consult your solicitor about reasonable fees

PITFALL 11: Assuming the Will is clear when it's not

THE MISTAKE: The Will says "divide my estate equally among my children," but one child is estranged,

or one was already given money during life. Executors guess what the deceased meant.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- If the Will is unclear, get legal advice
- Don't interpret it yourself
- If a Will is unclear, get legal advice. In some cases a solicitor can apply to the court for directions, but this is a technical step, so let your solicitor guide whether it is needed.
- Check this organiser for additional context (especially Part 8)

PITFALL 12: Not dealing with digital assets

THE MISTAKE: Executors forget about online accounts, subscriptions, cryptocurrency, and digital photos. The estate keeps getting charged, or valuable assets are lost.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Check Sections 20-23 for digital asset details
- Cancel subscriptions to stop charges
- Access cryptocurrency with recovery phrases (don't lose them)
- Download photos and important files before closing accounts

PITFALL 13: Letting family pressure influence decisions

THE MISTAKE: A beneficiary pressures the executor to give them "their share" early, or to interpret the Will in their favour. The executor caves to keep the peace.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Your job is to follow the Will, not make everyone happy
- Be very careful about distributing early. Generally you should wait until debts and claims are sorted, and any early distribution needs all beneficiaries to agree in writing (and sometimes the court's approval). Check with your solicitor first.
- Don't let anyone bully you
- Refer difficult family members to the solicitor
- Document any pressure or threats

PITFALL 14: Not valuing assets properly

THE MISTAKE: Executors guess at asset values instead of getting professional valuations. This causes

disputes and potential tax issues.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Get professional valuations for:
- Property
- Vehicles
- Businesses
- Collectibles
- Jewellery
- Art
- Keep valuation reports for your records
- Date-of-death values are often the right reference point, but the correct date can differ depending on the asset and the tax position, so check with your accountant or solicitor which to use.

PITFALL 15: Missing tax deadlines

THE MISTAKE: Executors don't realise the final tax return is due, or they miss the deadline. The ATO charges penalties and interest.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Work with the accountant (Section 19 has details)
- There's a final tax return to lodge, and there may be estate tax returns after that. The due dates depend on your circumstances and whether you use a tax agent, so check the timing with your accountant or the ATO rather than assuming a single deadline.
- Hold off distributing until the estate's tax affairs are confirmed to be in order. What that confirmation looks like varies, so check with the accountant or the ATO before you distribute.
- Keep funds in reserve for potential tax bills

PITFALL 16: Not understanding superannuation

THE MISTAKE: Executors assume super goes to the estate automatically. It doesn't. Super is paid according to the binding nomination, not the Will.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Check Section 11 for super details
- Contact the super fund immediately

- Check for binding vs non-binding nominations
- Some binding nominations expire after 3 years, but many funds offer non-lapsing ones that don't. Check the actual nomination and confirm its status with the super fund.
- Super can be paid to dependants or the estate

PITFALL 17: Underestimating how long it takes

THE MISTAKE: Executors tell beneficiaries "this will be done in a few months." A year later, it's still not settled, and everyone is angry.

HOW TO AVOID IT:

- Set realistic expectations from the start
- Tell beneficiaries: "Estates usually take 6-12 months minimum"
- Explain that delays are normal
- Update them regularly on progress
- Don't promise timelines you can't control

SUMMARY: THE GOLDEN RULES

1. Don't rush. Take your time and get it right.
2. Keep detailed records. Document everything.
3. Get professional help. Solicitors and accountants are worth it.
4. Communicate with beneficiaries. Transparency prevents conflict.
5. Follow the Will. Not family pressure.
6. Don't distribute until debts are paid and ATO clearance is received.
7. Open a separate estate bank account.
8. Get professional valuations.
9. Be patient with yourself. This is hard work.

You're doing your best. That's all anyone can ask.

Your Common Executor Pitfalls & How to Avoid Them

The mistakes that catch executors out, and a box to tick once you understand each.

PITFALLS TO UNDERSTAND AND AVOID

> *Each pitfall is explained above. Tick it once you understand how to avoid it.*

- [ ] 1. Distributing assets too soon (wait for ATO clearance and the creditor period)
- [ ] 2. Not keeping detailed records
- [ ] 3. Paying debts in the wrong order
- [ ] 4. Mixing personal and estate funds
- [ ] 5. Acting without probate when it's required
- [ ] 6. Ignoring or delaying communication with beneficiaries
- [ ] 7. Taking on too much alone
- [ ] 8. Selling assets too quickly (or too slowly)
- [ ] 9. Not advertising for creditors
- [ ] 10. Paying themselves without documentation
- [ ] 11. Assuming the Will is clear when it's not
- [ ] 12. Not dealing with digital assets
- [ ] 13. Letting family pressure influence decisions
- [ ] 14. Not valuing assets properly
- [ ] 15. Missing tax deadlines
- [ ] 16. Not understanding superannuation
- [ ] 17. Underestimating how long it takes

NOTES: WHICH OF THESE APPLY TO THIS ESTATE, AND HOW YOU'LL HANDLE THEM

Executor Expense Log Template

As an executor, you'll spend money on behalf of the estate.

Solicitor fees. Accountant fees. Funeral costs. Property valuations. Travel expenses. Postage. Death certificates. Probate application fees.

Most of these costs are met by the estate rather than coming out of your own pocket. In practice you may need to pay some expenses yourself first and then be reimbursed from the estate, as long as the cost was reasonable and properly incurred. If an estate looks like it may not have enough to cover its debts and expenses, get advice from a solicitor before paying anything. But you need to keep detailed records of every expense to prove what you spent and why.

This expense log helps you track everything.

Why keep detailed records?

Beneficiaries have the right to see how the estate's money was spent. If you can't prove an expense was legitimate, you might have to pay it back yourself.

Detailed records also protect you from accusations of mismanagement.

How to use this log:

Record every expense, no matter how small. Include the date, what it was for, who was paid, and the amount. Keep the receipt or invoice. At the end, you'll have a complete record of all estate expenses.

Let's track it all.

Your Executor Expense Log Template

Track every dollar spent on the estate, so your final accounting is clean and defensible.

ESTATE DETAILS

ESTATE OF

EXECUTOR NAME

DATE ESTATE OPENED

EXPENSE LOG

> *Record every expense. Note whether you paid it personally (to be reimbursed) or from the estate account. Keep all receipts.*

DATE	DESCRIPTION	PAYEE	AMOUNT	PAID FROM	RECEIPT

Your Executor Expense Log Template (cont.)

DATE	DESCRIPTION	PAYEE	AMOUNT	PAID FROM	RECEIPT

Your Executor Expense Log Template (cont.)

DATE	DESCRIPTION	PAYEE	AMOUNT	PAID FROM	RECEIPT

TOTALS AND NOTES

Notification Templates

After someone dies, you need to notify dozens of organisations.

Banks. Super funds. Centrelink. Insurance companies. Employers. Councils. Utilities. Each one needs to be told formally, usually in writing.

This section provides letter templates you can adapt and use.

These templates are starting points. You'll need to customise them with specific details (names, account numbers, dates). But they give you the structure and wording to make notifications easier.

How to use these templates:

1. Choose the template that matches who you're notifying
2. Fill in the bracketed information with your details
3. Attach a certified copy of the death certificate
4. Keep a copy of every letter you send
5. Follow up if you don't hear back within 2 weeks

Let's make notifications easier.

NOTIFICATION TEMPLATES FOR EXECUTORS

TEMPLATE 1: NOTIFICATION TO BANK

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]
[Your Email]

[Date]

[Bank Name]
[Branch Address]

Dear Sir/Madam,

Re: Notification of Death - [Deceased's Full Name]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who passed away on [Date of Death].

[Deceased's Name] held the following account(s) with your organisation:
- Account Name: [Account Name]
- Account Number: [Account Number]
- BSB: [BSB]

I am the executor of the estate of [Deceased's Name]. A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

Please advise me of the balance(s) as at the date of death and let me know what happens to each account now. I understand that accounts held in the deceased's sole name are usually frozen until probate, while jointly held accounts generally pass to the surviving account holder. Please confirm how each account is held and what steps you need from me. I will provide a copy of the Grant of Probate once it has been issued, if probate is required for this estate. Not every estate needs a Grant of Probate. Whether you need one depends on the size of the estate and how the assets are held, so check with the bank or a solicitor before applying.

Please also advise if there are any:
- Direct debits or automatic payments linked to this account
- Joint account holders
- Loans, credit cards, or other products in the deceased's name

I would appreciate your response within 14 days.

Yours faithfully,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]
Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 2: NOTIFICATION TO SUPERANNUATION FUND

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]
[Your Email]

[Date]

[Super Fund Name]
[Super Fund Address]

Dear Sir/Madam,

Re: Death Benefit Claim - [Deceased's Full Name]
Member Number: [Member Number]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who passed away on [Date of Death].

[Deceased's Name] was a member of your superannuation fund. A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

Please send me:
1. A death benefit claim form
2. Details of the current superannuation balance
3. Information about any binding or non-binding death benefit nomination on file
4. Details of any insurance held through the fund (life insurance, TPD, income protection)

I am the executor of the estate. Please advise what documentation you require to process the death benefit claim.

I would appreciate your response within 14 days.

Yours faithfully,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 3: NOTIFICATION TO CENTRELINK

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]

[Date]

Centrelink
[Local Centrelink Office Address]

Dear Sir/Madam,

Re: Notification of Death - [Deceased's Full Name]
Centrelink Reference Number (CRN): [CRN]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who passed away on [Date of Death].

[Deceased's Name] was receiving the following payment(s):
- [Payment Type, e.g., Age Pension, Carer Payment]

A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

Please cease all payments with effect from [Date of Death] and advise if any payments received after this date need to be repaid.

[If applicable: The deceased's spouse, [Spouse's Name], CRN [Spouse's CRN], may be eligible for bereavement payments. Please advise them of any entitlements.]

Please confirm receipt of this notification and advise of any further action required.

Yours faithfully,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 4: NOTIFICATION TO EMPLOYER

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]
[Your Email]

[Date]

[Employer Name]
[HR Department]
[Employer Address]

Dear Sir/Madam,

Re: Notification of Death - [Deceased's Full Name]
Employee Number: [Employee Number]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who was employed by your organisation as [Job Title]. [He/She] passed away on [Date of Death].

A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

As the executor of [Deceased's Name]'s estate, I request the following:

1. Final pay for any unpaid salary or wages
2. Payment of accrued annual leave and long service leave
3. Details of any superannuation contributions owing
4. Information about any life insurance or income protection policies through the employer
5. Details of any other entitlements (redundancy, bonuses, share options, etc.)

Please advise what documentation you require and the expected timeframe for payment of final entitlements.

Please send all correspondence to the address above.

Yours faithfully,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 5: NOTIFICATION TO INSURANCE COMPANY

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]
[Your Email]

[Date]

[Insurance Company Name]
[Claims Department]
[Insurance Company Address]

Dear Sir/Madam,

Re: Life Insurance Death Claim - [Deceased's Full Name]
Policy Number: [Policy Number]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], the insured person under the above policy. [He/She] passed away on [Date of Death].

A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

I am the executor of the estate of [Deceased's Name]. Please send me:
1. A claim form for the death benefit
2. Confirmation of the sum insured
3. Details of the nominated beneficiaries (if any)
4. A list of documents required to process the claim

Please advise the expected timeframe for processing this claim.

I would appreciate your response within 14 days.

Yours faithfully,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 6: NOTIFICATION TO UTILITY PROVIDER

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]

[Date]

[Utility Provider Name]
[Utility Provider Address]

Dear Sir/Madam,

Re: Notification of Death and Account Closure - [Deceased's Full Name]
Account Number: [Account Number]
Service Address: [Service Address]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who passed away on [Date of Death].

[Deceased's Name] held an account with your organisation for [electricity/gas/water/internet] service at the above address.

Please:
1. Transfer the account to my name as executor until the property is sold
OR
2. Close the account as of [Date] and send a final bill to the address below

Please send the final account statement and any refund owing to:
[Your Name]
[Your Address]

Yours faithfully,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

TEMPLATE 7: NOTIFICATION TO COUNCIL (RATES)

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]

[Date]

[Council Name]
Rates Department
[Council Address]

Dear Sir/Madam,

Re: Notification of Death - [Deceased's Full Name]
Property Address: [Property Address]
Assessment Number: [Assessment Number]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who was the owner of the above property. [He/She] passed away on [Date of Death].

I am the executor of the estate. A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

Please update your records and send all future correspondence regarding this property to:
[Your Name]
[Your Address]

Please advise if there are any outstanding rates owing.

Yours faithfully,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TEMPLATE 8: GENERAL NOTIFICATION LETTER

[Your Name]
[Your Address]
[Your Phone]
[Your Email]

[Date]

[Organisation Name]
[Organisation Address]

Dear Sir/Madam,

Re: Notification of Death - [Deceased's Full Name]
Account/Reference Number: [Number]

I am writing to notify you of the death of [Deceased's Full Name], who passed away on [Date of Death].

[Deceased's Name] held an account/membership/subscription with your organisation. A certified copy of the death certificate is enclosed.

Please:
1. Close the account/cancel the membership/subscription
2. Advise if there are any outstanding payments or refunds owing
3. Update your records to prevent further correspondence

Please send any final statements or refunds to:
[Your Name]
[Your Address]

Yours faithfully,

[Your Signature]
[Your Printed Name]
Executor for the Estate of [Deceased's Full Name]

Enclosures: Certified copy of death certificate

TIPS FOR USING THESE TEMPLATES

• Always include a certified copy of the death certificate
• Keep a copy of every letter you send
• Record the date sent and follow up if no response within 2 weeks
• Use registered post for important notifications
• Be clear about what you're requesting
• Include your contact details
• Be patient - some organisations take longer to respond than others

Your Notification Templates

A checklist of who to notify, and a place to track every notification you send.

WHO TO NOTIFY

- [ ] Banks (all accounts)
- [ ] Super funds
- [ ] Centrelink (if applicable)
- [ ] Department of Veterans' Affairs (if applicable)
- [ ] Employer
- [ ] Life insurance companies
- [ ] Health insurance
- [ ] Home & contents insurance
- [ ] Car insurance
- [ ] Council (rates)
- [ ] Electricity, gas and water providers
- [ ] Internet, phone and mobile providers
- [ ] Subscriptions (streaming, etc.)
- [ ] Gym / club memberships
- [ ] Professional associations
- [ ] Roadside assistance (NRMA, RACV, etc.)
- [ ] Australia Post (redirect mail)
- [ ] Electoral Commission
- [ ] Medicare
- [ ] Australian Taxation Office (via accountant)

Your Notification Templates (cont.)

RECORD OF NOTIFICATIONS SENT

Log each notification and follow up if you don't hear back within 2 weeks.

ORGANISATION	DATE SENT	RESPONSE RECEIVED?	FOLLOW-UP NEEDED?

Your Notification Templates (cont.)

ORGANISATION	DATE SENT	RESPONSE RECEIVED?	FOLLOW-UP NEEDED?

NOTES

WHAT COMES NEXT

This is one part of the bigger picture.

The Executor Toolkit is Part IX of the full Estate Organiser. The complete book is where your family records everything an executor needs, long before it is needed.

- Personal, medical and key-contact details
- The Will, executor, guardianship and funeral wishes
- Every account, asset, debt and policy in one place
- Digital life, legacy letters and final records

Get the complete Estate Organiser

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THE PRINTED BOOK

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